

Faculty of Science, Business and Enterprise / Chester Business School
Assessment Brief 2025/26

A: Assessment Details	
Module Title	Logistics and Transportation Management
Module Code	BU7077
Module Leader	Dr Marta Bell
Component Number	1 of 1
Assessment Type, Word Count & Weighting	Individual Assignment, 3000 words, 100%
Submission Window	The deadline is <u>1pm MONDAY 13th JULY 2026.</u>
	There will be a further 7-day submission window to <u>MONDAY 20th JULY 2026.</u> Work cannot be submitted after <u>1pm MONDAY 20th JULY 2026.</u>
	Further information is provided in Section I.
Submission Instructions	Submission of one MS Word document via Turnitin on the day of submission – please follow the instructions on Moodle.
Feedback Return Date	<u>20 working days from the close of the submission window</u>
Is this assessment eligible for In-Year Reassessment	Yes

B: Assessment Task
It is both incredibly tense and a very exciting time to be working in Logistics and Supply Chain Management globally. Uncontrollable pressures, particularly within an organisation's upstream and downstream supply chains, have resulted in significant challenges for most Logistics and Supply Chain managers this year. These issues require both reactive and long-term strategic change to continue to survive and prosper. With that in mind, choose a UK-based retailer (they may have physical stores, be omni-channel or be purely online). Assume that you are a global supply chain and logistics manager for the retailer, dealing with both up and downstream chains. Go and visit the retailer, its website (or both) and choose a product they currently sell to UK customers. The product must be produced by a manufacturer/supplier located overseas and then imported and distributed into the UK via their retail channels. Required: The Chief Executive Officer (CEO) has asked you to produce a comprehensive report about the global supply chain, up and downstream logistics and competitors for this product, as part of the company's future product choices. The CEO has also reminded you to provide two-sided arguments, including barriers and enablers, to justify any product supply chain and logistics changes that you may wish to propose. You will need to critically support your analysis and proposals with reference to relevant literature or other secondary sources and learning from the module itself. You will be expected to provide at least 10 separate references from relevant sources to support your assertions.

Your report must address the following tasks:

1. Name the retailer, the chosen product and the country where the existing product is produced. Provide sufficient background information about the retailer, the market/s it operates in and the market/s in which the chosen product operates in. Describe the competition within the existing market/s and whether this product is successful as a profit generator for the retailer. Perform research to explain who has the buying power in this scenario and whether the product is suitable for the retailer's portfolio and its current customers. Discuss the positives and negatives of continuing to source the chosen product from the existing country of origin/supplier. Support your suggestions with published and evidential proof alongside theoretical/practical arguments. (15 marks)
2. Describe and analyse the current transportation modes (air, sea, rail, road) used to import the product in its current supply chain scenario - all the way from the supplier/manufacturer's country of origin to a warehouse of the individual retailer in the UK. You are expected to show the locations of warehouses, distribution centres and the retail stores in a UK map (If you can't find this information, you may look to suggest the best potential locations). (15 marks)
3. Select **one** of the following options:
 - (a) Discuss whether the retailer could possibly source this same product from an alternative country/supplier and describe how this new product country/supplier will benefit the retail organization in either lower cost, higher quality, increased reliability or appropriateness to existing customer demands. The potential impacts of reliability, tariffs and exchange rates on those decisions should be discussed with supporting proof.
 - (b) Discuss whether the retailer should replace this product with an alternative product and describe how this new product country/supplier will benefit the retail organization in either lower cost, higher quality, increased reliability or appropriateness to existing customer demands. The potential impacts of reliability, tariffs and exchange rates on those decisions should be discussed with supporting proof.
 - (c) Discuss whether the product should be produced by the retailer themselves, in a vertical supply chain scenario. Describe how this new product scenario will benefit the retail organization in either lower cost, higher quality, increased reliability or appropriateness to existing customer demands. The potential impacts of reliability, tariffs and exchange rates on those decisions should be discussed with supporting proof.
 - (d) Discuss whether the product may be better 'reshored' back to the UK. Describe how this new product scenario will benefit the retail organisation in either lower cost, higher quality, increased reliability or appropriateness to existing customer demands. The potential impacts of reliability, tariffs and exchange rates (if applicable) on those decisions should be discussed with supporting proof.(15 marks)
4. Select **one** of the following options. **This must be consistent with your choice for task 3 above.**
 - (a) Design a cost-effective and manageable supply and distribution network for the new scenario. Describe potential suitable port(s) of export at the country of origin and the port(s) of import within the UK for the new product choice. Critically support your suggestions with convincing theoretical arguments and additional information about each port and network design.

- (b) Design a cost-effective and manageable supply and distribution network for the new product. Describe potential suitable port(s) of export at the country of origin and the port(s) of import within the UK for the new product choice. Critically support your suggestions with convincing theoretical arguments and additional information about each port and network design.
- (c) Design a cost-effective and manageable supply and distribution network for the new vertical supply chain scenario, provide an upstream and downstream distribution network, possible partnerships, and justify the reasons for those decisions. Critically support your suggestions with convincing theoretical arguments and additional information about each port and network design. (20 marks)
- (d) In the case of a reshored proposal, provide an upstream and downstream distribution network, possible partnerships and justify the reasons for those decisions. Critically support your suggestions with convincing theoretical arguments and additional information about each port and network design. (20 marks)
5. Suggest suitable Incoterms for the upstream supply chain, whether that be improvements to the existing supply chain (a), new product provision (b), a vertical supply chain (c) or a reshored product scenario (d). Choose suitable freight forwarders or logistics service providers to handle the import and inbound logistics activities, where appropriate. Justify those decisions. Illustrate, using a process diagram, all the main parties involved, main activities and all documentation required to manage the imports of the product all the way from the supplier/manufacture at the country of origin to the warehouse in the UK and the stores/customers. (15 marks)
6. Consider recent barriers and enablers that may disrupt or improve the supply of the new product choice, from the country of origin all the way to the UK retailer (e.g., Brexit, trade-war, political tension, war, climate change, economic crisis, new regulations, new tariffs etc.). Identify the three most critical issues for the product and justify why the retailer should focus on them. Suggest how the retailer might govern and control the risks of sustainability, cost of imports, tariffs, government legislation and the effects on the reliability and total cost of ownership of the new product supply chain and logistics process caused by these issues. In addition, discuss how logistics managers face and propose how they could overcome the distinctive challenges within the organisational, cultural, teamwork, and leadership aspects of their multifaceted role. (20 Marks)

C: Specific Criteria, Guidance & Support	Please note that this is an individual task. Specific assessment support will be provided in class. Please see timetable for assignment support sessions. You may also wish to contact the Academic Skills Team (ASK) for additional support. Students must review the Assessment Checklist which can be found in the Moodle module assessment tile.
D: Learning Outcomes	COMP1: Critically analyse the overarching strategies, objectives, and operational directions of major logistics and transportation systems. COMP2: Reflect critically on the application of logistics and transportation management theories, principles and techniques relevant to different geographical or industrial contexts. COMP3: Demonstrate a critical awareness of how to design, implement, and manage effective logistics and transportation systems. COMP4: Understand the competencies a logistics manager needs and the distinctive challenges they face in organisational, cultural, teamwork, and leadership aspects. COMP5: Use a range of fundamental logistics management tools and techniques including, but not limited to, inventory management, warehouse operations, transportation route planning.
E: Key Resources	Christopher, M. (2022). Logistics and supply chain management, 6th ed., Pearson. Creazza, A., Dallari, F. and Melacinin M. (2010). Evaluating logistics network configurations for a global supply chain, Supply Chain Management: an International Journal, 15(2), 154-164. Grant, D.B., Trautrimis, A., and Wong, C.Y. (2022). Sustainable Logistics and Supply Chain Management, 3rd ed., Kogan Page. Mangan, J., Lalwani, C., and Calatayud, A. (2025). Global logistics and supply chain management, 6th ed., John Wiley & Sons. Manners-Bell, J. (2023). Supply Chain Risk Management: How to design and manage resilient supply chains, 4th ed., Kogan Page. Pedroletti, D., and Ciabuschi, F. (2023). Reshoring: A review and research agenda, Journal of Business Research, 164. Rushton, A., Croucher, P., and Baker, P. (2022). The handbook of logistics and distribution management (4th ed.). Kogan Page.

Selviaridis, K., Spring, M., Profillidis, V., and Botzoris, G. (2008). Benefits, risks, selection criteria and success factors for third party logistics services, *Maritime Economics & Logistics*, 10, 380-392.

Sheikh, W., Miah, S.M.A.N., Hasan, M.T., Zitu, K.K. and Hosain, J. (2024). Optimising international trade: the examination of Incoterms selection by exporters and importers, *Review of International Business and Strategy*, 34, 4, 562-583.

Skipworth, H., van Hoek, R., Aitken, J., and Harrison, A. (2025). Logistics Management and Strategy: Competing through the Supply Chain, 7th edition, Pearson.

Wamba, S.F. and Queiroz, M.M., 2020. Blockchain in the operations and supply chain management: Benefits, challenges and future research opportunities. *Int. J. of Information Management*, 52.

F: Submission Guidance

- You must submit assessments in **Microsoft Word**
- The file must be no larger than 100MB.
- Your writing is expected to conform to Standard English in terms of spelling, syntax, and grammar.
- Include your word count at the end of the assignment or the front cover.
- Set up your page for A4 paper in portrait style.
- The font size must be a minimum of point 12 Calibri (or equivalent) for the body of the assessment;
- Line spacing in the body of the assessment must be 1.5 lines.
- Number the pages consecutively.
- Students should submit work before 1pm UK/BST time (unless otherwise specified above in part A) on the deadline date electronically via Moodle. Please follow the 'Turnitin submission' link on the module space and follow the on-screen instructions, paying particular attention to any specific instructions for each assignment.
- You must submit your work with the following details written on the first page:
 - Title of your work
 - Module title and code
 - Module Leader and Seminar Tutor (if relevant)
 - Number of words
 - Your student assessment number (J Number)

Student work that does not have this information on will not be identifiable after marking has taken place and risks being recorded as a non-submission.

G: Academic Conduct and Penalties

It is your responsibility to ensure that you are familiar with all of the information contained in this brief as failure to do this may impact on your achievement.

Please refer to the various Assessment Guidance below for detailed information on:

[Academic Conduct](#)

[Excess Word Count Penalties](#)

[Cite Them Right Online guidance](#)

H: Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

For this assessment task, ***you are permitted*** to use AI tools, under these conditions:

1. You may use AI tools in the early phases of planning your submission, to structure and plan your assessment, but any ideas obtained by this means must be referenced and supported by credible academic or industry sources.
2. You must declare at the start of the submission how you have used the tools to plan any elements of the assessment task and provide the prompts (or questions) you used.
3. AI tools that are linked to spelling, punctuation, and grammar (e.g., Grammarly, Draft Coach) may be used within this assignment.
4. You **must not** use GenAI to write all or any part of the assignment. This would be a breach of academic conduct and could lead to a serious penalty.

The University [Academic Conduct Policy](#) explains how students are expected to take responsibility for the fair presentation of the contents of any work they present for assessment. This includes acknowledging the use of Artificial Intelligence tools. Breaching the academic conduct policy can have serious penalties.

There is guidance on how to reference artificial intelligence generated content in the [Generative Artificial Intelligence \(GenAI\) Moodle module](#).

I: Extensions, Deferrals and Assessment Regulations

- Students no longer need to self-certify in support of a request to submit up to 7 calendar days late as there will now be a 7-calendar day submission window from the date of the deadline, during which students can submit without penalty.
- Where a submission window exists, once this closes after the 7 days ***no further submissions are allowed***.
- If a student hasn't submitted their assessment by this point, or if they have submitted the assessment but feel their performance was affected, they then have a further 7 calendar days from the closure of the submission window to submit a deferral request (see below), and in all cases, evidence will be required to support the deferral.
- If a student does not complete the assessment, does not submit the assessment within the 7-day window, and does not defer, a non-submission (zero) will be recorded.

On the Registry [Exceptional Circumstances Portal](#) page you can find details on:

- The evidence needed to be granted a deferral of the assessment, without penalty, to the next assessment point

The online application system for these is available via: <https://v3apps.chester.ac.uk/oed>

J: Rubrics and Criteria

	Suggested marking guide	Marks
1	Provide sufficient background information about the retailer, the competition and the market/s and use relevant theory to discuss the positives and negatives of the current sourcing arrangements in place.	15
2	Describe and analyse the current transportation modes (air, sea, rail, road) used to import the product in its current supply chain scenario.	15
3	Choose one of four options for discussion.	15
4	Following on from Q3, select a suitable design for the upstream and downstream networks of the supply chain.	20
5	Choose suitable freight forwarders or logistics service providers within the supply chain and present a process diagram and Incoterms for all involved parties, activities and documentation.	15
6	Consider recent barriers and enablers that may disrupt or improve the supply of the new product choice and move on to discuss how logistics managers could overcome the distinctive challenges within their organisational, cultural, teamwork, and leadership aspects.	20
		100

Please see also attached marking criteria for Level 7.

	Distinction 90–100% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Distinction 80-89% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Distinction 70-79% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Merit 60-69% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Pass 50-59% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 40-49% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 30-39% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 20-29% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 10-19% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 0-9% <i>Evidence of...</i>
Knowledge Knowledge and understanding of the academic discipline, field of study, or area of professional practice. SCOPE: critical engagement with the primary and secondary sources used to answer the question.	Insightful and sophisticated engagement with research and/or practice pertaining to field(s) and disciplines of study; Sophisticated demonstration and application of knowledge, offering innovative and/or original insights, possibly unparalleled in their application; A sophisticated degree of synthesis, quite likely of complex and disparate material.	Advanced engagement with research and or practice pertaining to the field(s) and disciplines of study; Accomplished demonstration of knowledge, contributing towards innovative and/or original insights; Extremely high degree of synthesis of research material.	A high degree of engagement with research and/or practice pertaining to field(s) and disciplines of study; Excellent demonstration of knowledge, with the possibility for new insights; A high degree of synthesis relating to research material.	Sustained engagement with research and/or practice pertaining to disciplines of study; An assured understanding of current problems, supported by critical analysis with the potential for new insights; A sustained application and depth of research material and accuracy in detail.	Engagement with relevant knowledge pertaining to discipline and key issues; Satisfactory understanding and conceptual awareness enabling critical analysis; Response is appropriate and addresses the range of learning outcomes; where the knowledge is accurate. Work may lack sustained depth.	Unsatisfactory engagement with relevant knowledge pertaining to discipline and key issues; Insufficient understanding and conceptual awareness of knowledge(s) pertaining to the field; Response does not address the full range of learning outcomes, inaccurate and/or missing knowledge at times.	Inadequate coverage of relevant issues, inconsistent understanding shown; Inadequate understanding of underpinning issues, weak and underdeveloped analysis; Response does not address learning outcomes, inaccurate and missing knowledge.	Lack of relevant research and little understanding shown; Very weak understanding of key issues, work lacks critical oversight; Substandard engagement with research material, misunderstanding evident.	Severely lacking in relevant research and underpinning knowledge; Slight understanding of key issues, little attempt at critical analysis; Slight engagement with research material, inaccurate knowledge and misunderstanding throughout.	Negligible understanding of key issues, which is likely to show no critical analysis or engagement with the learning brief; No engagement with research tasks.

	Distinction 90–100% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Distinction 80–89% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Distinction 70–79% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Merit 60–69% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Pass 50–59% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 40–49% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 30–39% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 20–29% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 10–19% <i>Evidence of...</i>	Fail 0–9% <i>Evidence of...</i>
Sources Reading and use of appropriate sources. SCOPE: accurate and consistent acknowledgment and referencing of sources.	Extensive range and sophisticated use of appropriate sources; Unparalleled standard of research both in breadth and depth, which demonstrates a very high intellectual engagement and rigor.	Extensive range and use of appropriate sources; Extremely well referenced research both in breadth and depth, which demonstrates high intellectual engagement and rigor.	Substantial range and sophisticated use of sources; Well-referenced research both in breadth and depth, which demonstrates clear intellectual rigor.	An assured range of reading, with sustained reference to key and core texts. The work may include current research at the leading edge of the discipline; Very good referencing in breadth and/or depth, which shows a very good level of intellectual rigor; Sources acknowledged appropriately according to academic conventions of referencing.	A satisfactory range of core and basic texts, which references current research in the discipline; Sources acknowledged appropriately according to academic conventions of referencing. The work may contain minor errors and be limited in breadth, depth and intellectual rigor.	Insufficient range of source reading of core and basic texts; Sources not acknowledged in line with academic conventions of referencing.	Reading material is inadequate and may not include core and basic texts; Sources inaccurately referenced.	Very weak engagement with source reading of core and basic texts; Inconsistent and/or limited referencing of sources.	Severely lacking source reading; Sources either not present and/or not referenced.	Negligible attempt to identify source material; No indication of source reading.
Methodology SCOPE: critical engagement with methodologies underpinning original research or current developments in the discipline.	Insightful and sophisticated interpretation, application and evaluation of the possibilities and limitations of the methodologies used by the student and key scholars/practitioners pertaining to the field(s) of study; Methods used offer new insights and contributions to knowledge.	Advanced interpretation, application and evaluation of the possibilities and limitations of the methodologies used by the student and key scholars/practitioners pertaining to the field(s) of study; Methods used contribute towards new insights to knowledge.	Excellent interpretation, application and evaluation of the possibilities and limitations of the methodologies used by the student and key scholars/practitioners pertaining to the field(s) of study; Methods used may offer new insights or contributions to knowledge.	A comprehensive understanding shown and a sustained application of established methodologies and methods applicable to the student's own research; Research work planned in scale and scope so that robust and appropriate evidence can be gathered and articulated.	A satisfactory application of research techniques and enquiry that are used to create and interpret knowledge in the discipline; Research work planned systematically in scale and scope so that appropriate evidence can be gathered.	Unsatisfactory application of research techniques pertaining to the discipline; Unsatisfactory research undertaken, resulting in underdeveloped and poorly executed work.	An underdeveloped understanding of established methodologies and those used by the student; Research work is weak and executed inaccurately.	Very weak understanding of established methodologies and those used by student; Substandard research, methods mainly erroneous.	Research works show very little planning and understanding; Erroneous use of methods to explain the work.	Negligible understanding of established research methods and those used by the student; No research methods evident.

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Analysis Critical analysis and interpretation. SCOPE: appropriate analytical discussion and interpretation of source material.	A sophisticated command of imaginative, insightful, original or creative interpretations; An unparalleled level of analysis and evaluation; A sophisticated cogent argument offering new and original contributions to knowledge.	Advanced command of imaginative, insightful, original or creative interpretations; Accomplished level of analysis and evaluation; A highly developed cogent argument with the potential to bring new and original contributions to knowledge.	An excellent command of imaginative, original or creative interpretations; A high degree of analysis and evaluation; A sustained argument with the possibility for new insights to knowledge.	A convincing and sustained command of accepted critical positions; A developed conceptual understanding that enables the student to find new meanings in established hypotheses; A developed and sustained argument with the possibility for new insights to knowledge.	An ability to deal with complex issues both systematically and creatively; A satisfactory evaluation of current research and critical scholarship in the discipline; Ability to devise a coherent critical/ analytical argument is supported with evidence.	A lack of ability to deal with complex issues; Judgements not fully substantiated and understood; The ability to construct an argument is underdeveloped and not supported fully with evidence.	A lack of ability to deal with complex issues; Judgements are not substantiated or understood and the critical position is not made clear; Weak interpretation of research and work is not supported with evidence.	Very weak analysis, possibly limited to a single perspective; Substandard argument, work lacks scholarly analysis and interpretation; Episodes of self-contradiction and/or confusion.	Slight indication of ability to deal with key issues; Slight analytical engagement and reflection, work lacks criticality throughout; Lacks evidence, work shows self-contradiction and confusion.	Negligible coverage of learning outcomes; No attempt to interpret research material.
Communication Communication skills: creative, written and presented. SCOPE: communication of intent, adherence to academic subject discipline protocols.	A sophisticated response, the academic form matches that expected in published and professional work; Mastery and command of specialist skills pertaining to the academic form; Idiomatic and highly coherent, scholarly expression.	Persuasive articulation, where the academic form largely matches that expected in published work; Accomplished command of specialist skills pertaining to the academic form, discipline and context(s);	A high degree of skill, the academic form shows exceptional standards of presentation or delivery; A high command of specialist skills pertaining to the academic form, discipline and context(s).	Secure and sustained expression, observing appropriate academic form; Fluent and persuasive expression of ideas, work shows flair; Assured interpretation of the style and genre, content, form and technique for specialist and non-specialist audiences as appropriate.	Good expression, observing appropriate academic form; Predominantly accurate in spelling and grammar, ideas communicated appropriately and satisfactorily; Satisfactory application of specialist skills with effective technical control.	Unsatisfactory demonstration and application of key communication skills; Recurring errors in spelling and grammar, ideas limited and underdeveloped, possibly poor paraphrasing; Skills demonstrated are insufficient for the task and work may lack technical judgement.	Significant errors evident in the academic form; Weaknesses in spelling and grammar, lacks coherence and structure, possibly poor paraphrasing; Work lacks technical judgement.	Very weak observation of academic conventions; Severe deficiencies in spelling and grammar and expression undermines meaning, possibly poor paraphrasing; Substandard relationship between content, form and technique.	Slight observation of academic conventions; Weak expression, mostly incoherent and fails to secure meaning, poor paraphrasing; Slight engagement with the work.	Negligible observation of academic conventions; Incoherent and confused expression, poor paraphrasing; No discernible demonstration of key skills (pertaining to the discipline); No engagement with the work.

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Reflection Critical reflection and/or personal and professional application. SCOPE: Intellectual engagement with the processes by which the work is realised.	Insightful response to critical self-evaluation, reflecting exemplary professional and/or personal standards of engagement and conduct throughout; Sophisticated application of new insights (or highly advanced application of established ways of working pertaining to the discipline).	Advanced level of critical self-evaluation, reflecting professional and/or personal standards of engagement and conduct throughout; Accomplished application of new insights (or advanced application of established ways of working pertaining to the discipline).	A high degree of critical self-evaluation, reflecting professional and/or personal standards of engagement and conduct; Excellent application of new insights (or a highly skilled application of established ways of working pertaining to the discipline).	An assured level of self-evaluation, reflecting sustained professional and/or personal standards of engagement and conduct; Assured application of new or established ways of working; Work evidences thorough independent planning and execution of key tasks.	A satisfactory self evaluation, reflecting appropriate standards of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; Satisfactory engagement with established ways of working pertaining to the discipline; Independent planning and execution.	Unsatisfactory self-evaluation of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; Unsatisfactory engagement with established ways of working pertaining to the discipline; Insufficient planning, work not executed in full.	Weak self-evaluation of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; Weak engagement with established ways of working pertaining to the discipline; Inadequate planning.	Very weak self-evaluation of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; Substandard engagement with established ways of working; Inappropriate execution of work.	Slight evidence of self-evaluation of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; Inappropriate execution of key tasks and work may be a cause for concern.	Negligible evidence of self-evaluation of professional and/or personal engagement and conduct; No engagement with established ways of working; In professional or equivalent contexts the work will be cause for concern.